



Aeria Policy Document

1. Document Control / Header Information

Title

CRM - Pressure & Stress Management Policy

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CRM1016

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Feb 1, 2026

Prepared By

[Dustin Wales](#)

Approved By

[Dustin Wales](#)

Amendment / Revision History

Date	Description of Change	Approved By
Sep 16, 2025	Initial release of the new document style	Dustin Wales
Date	[Description of change]	Person
Date	[Description of change]	Person

2. Purpose & Scope

Purpose

To establish structured protocols for recognizing, managing, and mitigating pressure and stress during RPAS operations. Effective stress management ensures operators remain composed, make sound decisions, and maintain operational safety even under high pressure conditions.

Scope

Applies to all Aeria RPAS operational personnel, including Pilots in Command (PICs), Visual Observers (VOs), Operations Managers, subcontractors, and all supporting staff engaged in mission activities.

3. Definitions & References

Definitions

- Pressure: External demands or expectations placed on operators (e.g., deadlines, client requirements).
- Stress: Physical, mental, or emotional strain caused when demands exceed perceived capacity.

- Stressors: Internal or external factors that may impair judgment, communication, or performance.

References

- Aeria CRM Manual, Section: Pressure and Stress Management
- Aeria HSE Policy: Stress & Fatigue Management
- Transport Canada Advisory Circular 700-042, Appendix A

4. Policy Statement

Aeria Solutions requires that all RPAS crew recognize and proactively manage pressure and stress to maintain mission safety and effectiveness. Operators must use structured strategies and escalation protocols to reduce stress impacts and openly communicate when stress levels compromise performance.

5. Procedures

Step-by-Step Actions

Pre-Mission (Anticipate Stress):

- Conduct stress self-assessment and share potential stressors during the team briefing.
- Identify external demands (client expectations, weather, deadlines) that could create pressure.

During Mission (Manage Stress):

- Apply stress-reduction techniques such as tactical breathing, visualization, and goal setting.
- Rotate tasks during long missions to avoid cognitive overload.
- Use P.A.C.E. escalation protocol if stress is compromising decision-making or safety.

Post-Mission (Debrief & Learn):

- Conduct structured debrief to review stressors encountered.
- Document effective strategies and lessons learned for continuous improvement.

Roles & Responsibilities for Each Step

- PIC: Monitor own and crew stress levels; reprioritize tasks or initiate task reassignment when required.



- VO: Report observed stress behaviors in PIC or crew; support PIC with workload balance.
- Operations Manager: Address high-stress conditions during planning; allocate adequate resources and time.
- Crew Members: Self-report stress levels and apply coping strategies.

Tools, Forms, or Checklists to be Used

- Pre-Mission Stress Self-Assessment Checklist
- P.A.C.E. Communication Protocol for stress escalation
- Post-Mission Stress Review Log

Safety/Compliance/Quality Requirements

- Compliance with CARs 901.19 (crew fitness for duty).
- Integration with Aeria's HSE Fatigue and Stress Management Policy.

Reporting or Escalation Processes

- Stress-related issues reported during debriefs.
- Critical stress conditions escalated immediately to Operations Manager or Accountable Executive.

6. Roles & Responsibilities

Management

- Provide training on stress recognition and coping strategies.
- Monitor stress-related trends from debrief reports.

Supervisors

- Reinforce stress reduction practices during mission planning and briefings.
- Ensure adequate rest and workload distribution.

Staff

- Apply stress management strategies.





- Report if stress impacts safe performance.

7. Monitoring, Compliance & Enforcement

How Compliance Will Be Monitored

- Field audits of team communication and stress handling.
- Review of post-mission debrief logs for stress-related issues.
- Annual refresher training on stress and pressure management.

Consequences for Non-Compliance

- Corrective coaching or retraining for lapses in stress management.
- Disciplinary action if unmanaged stress leads to unsafe operation.

Reporting Obligations

- Stress-related incidents documented in mission reports.
- Significant stress-related operational risks reported to Accountable Executive.

8. Sign-Off & Acknowledgment

Approval Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Author	Dustin Wales		Sep 16, 2025
Reviewer	Person		Date
Approver	Person		Date



Employee Acknowledgment Section

I, Person , acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the terms and conditions outlined in this Policy & Procedure document.

Date: Date